



BOULDER VALLEY
SCHOOL DISTRICT

Board of Education | October 17, 2023

School Attendance Area Policy JC

Worksession

Introduction

Authority to establish attendance areas

- C.R.S. 22-32-110(1)(m) Power to fix attendance areas
- Board of Education has authority to determine school boundaries



Existing Policy JC

- Created in 2019; replaced outdated version from before 1978
- Gives direction on processing boundary change
- Considerations for:
 - Compactness of boundaries
 - Student densities vs. school capacity
 - Balance enrollment between schools
 - Maximization of pedestrian access
 - Efficient use of BVSD transportation
 - Residency criteria

JC

J STUDENTS

File: JC (pdf)

Adopted: February 26, 2019

School Attendance Areas

Attendance areas for each school of the district shall be drawn up by the administration and approved by the Board, based on geography and student population projections.

In establishing school boundaries, consideration shall be given to the compactness of the boundaries, the densities of students in an area in relation to the relative capacities of the schools, the equalization of enrollments between schools, the maximization of pedestrian access to schools, and efficient use of transportation facilities.

A student's designated attendance area shall be based on the legal residence of the parents/guardians. Where a property straddles a boundary line separating two schools, the property shall be considered within the school boundary that contains the point where the property driveway accesses the public right-of-way.

LEGAL REF.: C.R.S. 22-32-110(1)(m) (power to fix attendance areas)

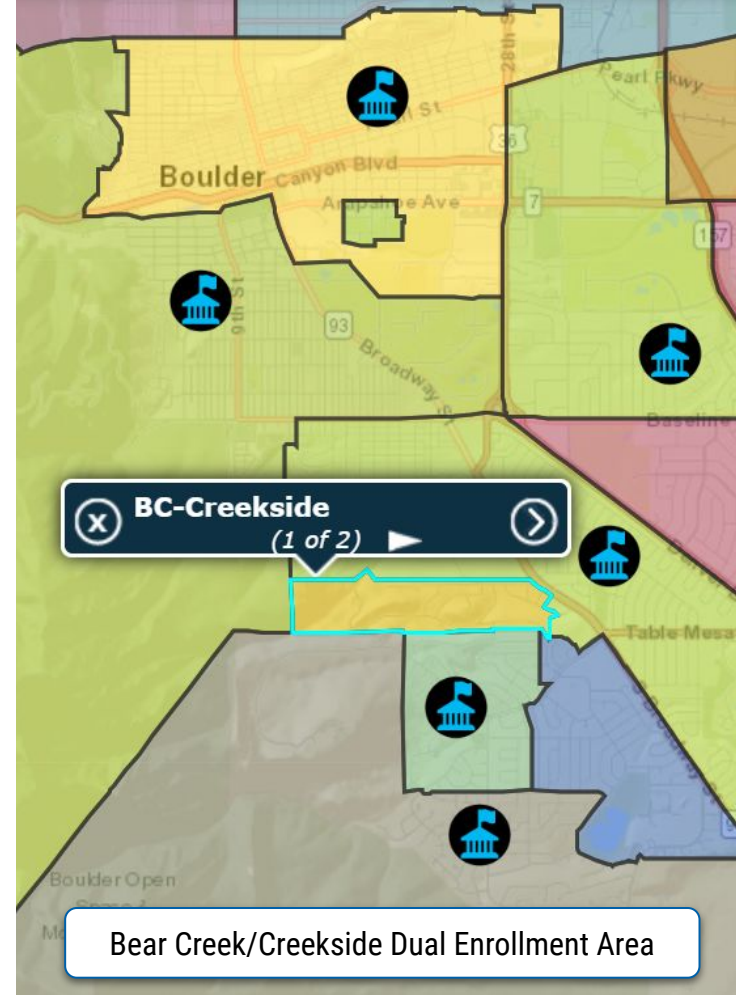
CROSS REF.: JECC-R - Open Enrollment Procedures & Information

End of File: JC



Existing Boundaries

- Core boundaries from at least early 1980's
 - New schools added/closed
 - Handful of small tweaks
- Split Feeders
- Dual Enrollment Areas
 - Bear Creek/Creekside/Mesa
 - Boulder High/Fairview
 - Casey/Manhattan (3 year transition)
- Non-contiguous enrollment areas
 - Columbine
 - Whittier
 - Creekside



Reasons for Changing Attendance Boundaries

- Opening a new school, changing a neighborhood school to non-neighborhood (focus), or closing a school
- Fix a specific inefficiency or impracticality
- Balance base residential student population among schools
- Attempt to optimize resources
- Goal of fostering community cohesion
- Attempt to address demographic shifts or rebalancing composition



Limitations of Changing Boundaries

- Can only redistribute base resident populations, not overall enrollment
- Enrollment is a function of many factors besides resident population, including open enrollment, program options, and community values
- Innately disruptive to families and neighborhoods (siblings, home purchases, attachment to a school community)
- Unintended consequences (e.g. community division, transportation impacts)
- Concessions may water down gains in short term
- Not a precise tool in eliminating inequalities
- Some stakeholders will inevitably be dissatisfied



Recent Boundary Changes in BVSD

- Meadowlark/Lafayette El. (Erie, 2016)
- Blue Sage/Eagle Place (Louisville/Lafayette, 2015)
- Louisville El. & LMS crowding discussions (2012/2014)
- Sugarloaf and Superior (2007/08)
- Superior/Louisville/Lafayette dual areas (2007)
- Indian Peaks South (Louisville/Lafayette, 2005)
- School closures/consolidations (2003)



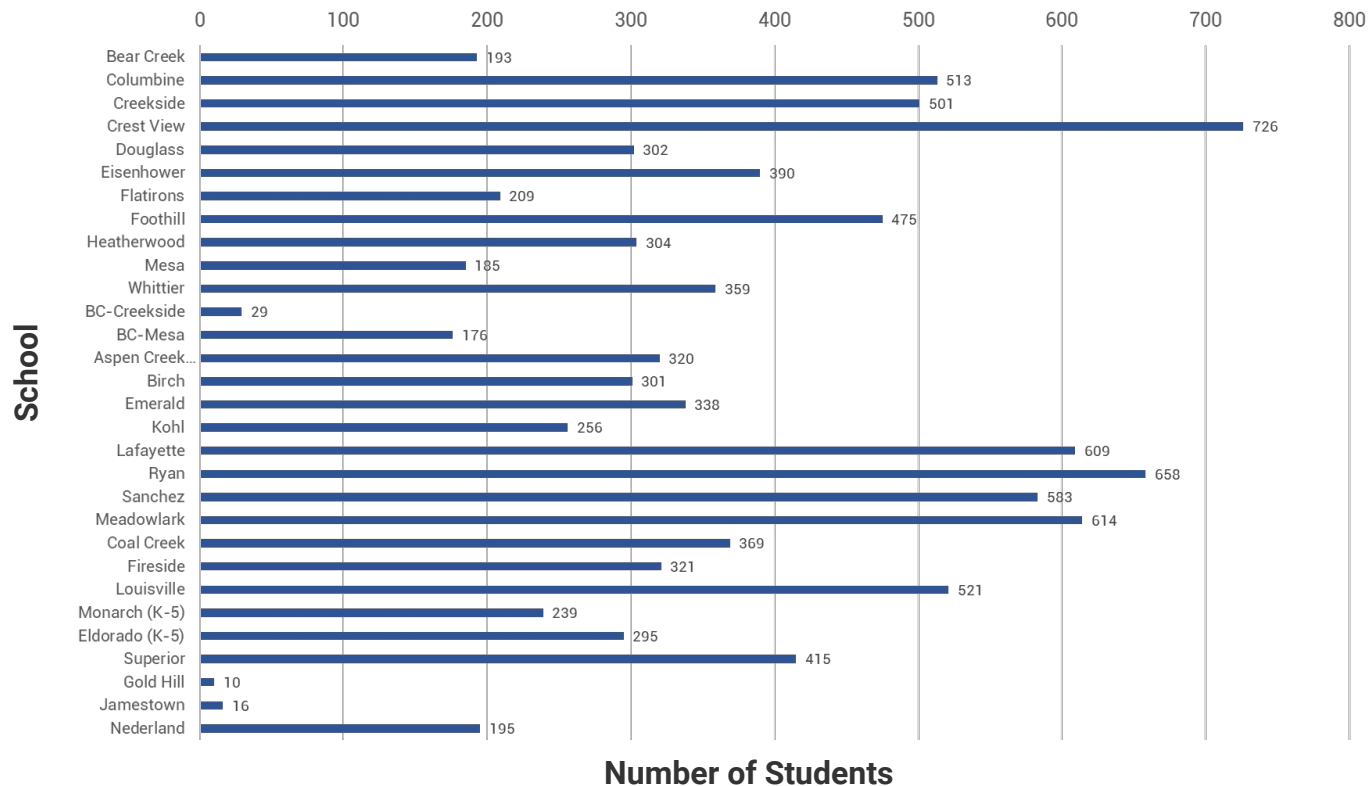
BVSD Overall Boundaries

BVSD has not undertaken a district-wide boundary review in over 40 years.

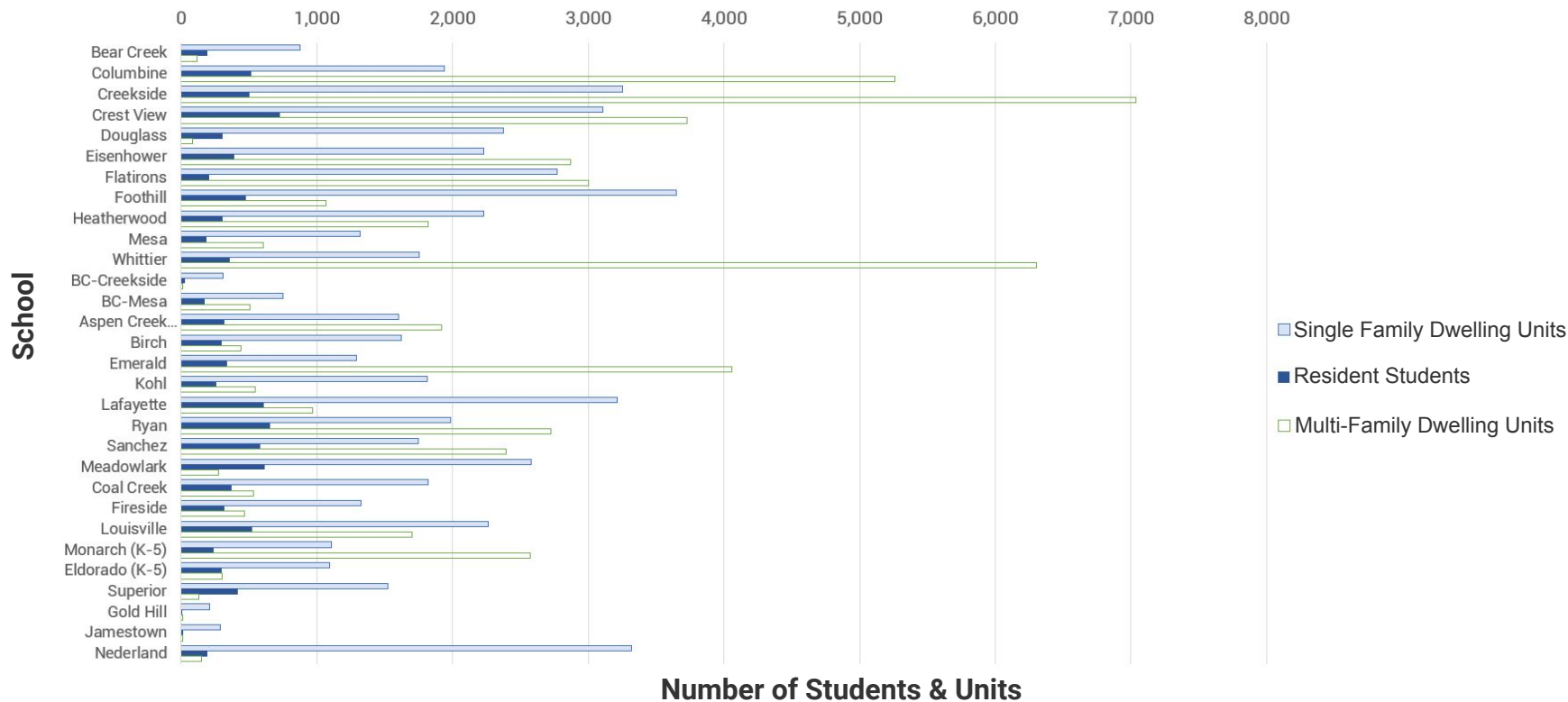
Elementary School Attendance Area Boundaries



Number of Resident Students per Elem. School

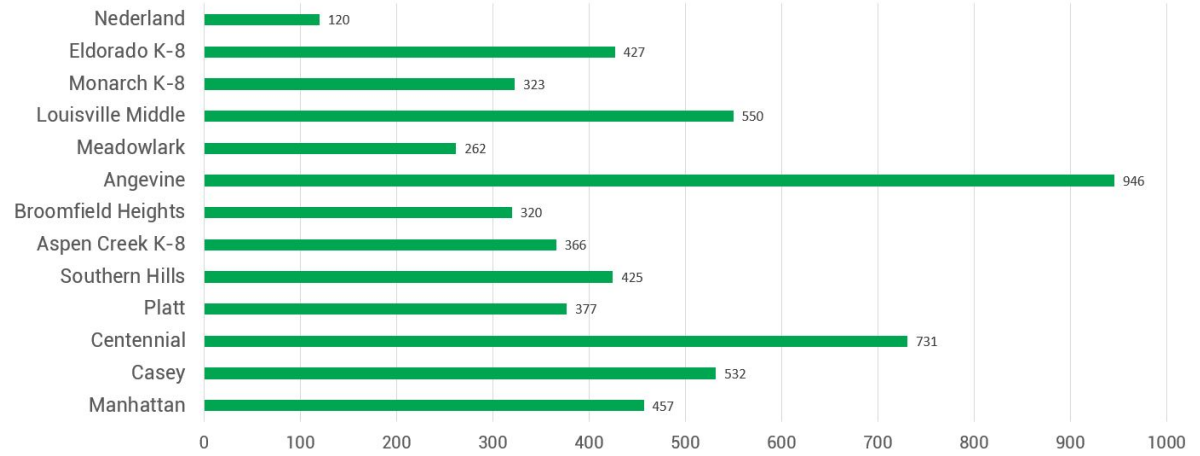


Housing and Resident Students per Elem. School

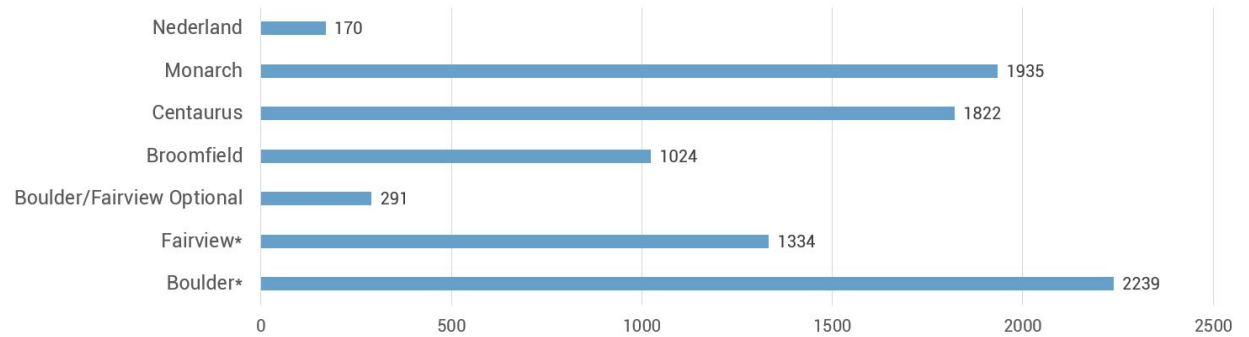


Resident Secondary Students

Resident Students by Middle School



Resident Students by High School



* Does not include dual enrollment area



Comparison with Other Districts' Policies

SIMILARITIES

- Attendance area determination and factors considered
- Differences in transportation and property boundary considerations
- Residence-based designation

DIFFERENCES

- BVSD has a culture of stable boundaries
- Process and timing of changes, reporting requirements, and factors for modification
- Development of boundary plans, conditions and considerations for redistricting
 - Consideration of educational programs, social, transportation, and administrative factors
- Impact on current students affected by attendance area change



Interplay with Other Policies & Law

- Open Enrollment Policy JECC, JECC-R
- Schools of Choice law, C.R.S. 22-36-101
- Focus Schools Policy IFF
- Mitigating disruptions
- Impact on enrollment numbers
- Challenges for capacity planning
- Consideration of capacity and open enrollment



Board Enrollment Discussions

Oct. 10: Enrollment Survey Data

Oct. 17: School Attendance Areas Policy JC

Oct. 24: Open Enrollment Policy JECC & JECC-R

Nov. 14: Focus School Policy IFF

Discussion

